Windows IT support lab – Olivia Hudson

Task 1: Gather System Information

Objective

Locate basic system information using Windows System Information (msinfo32).

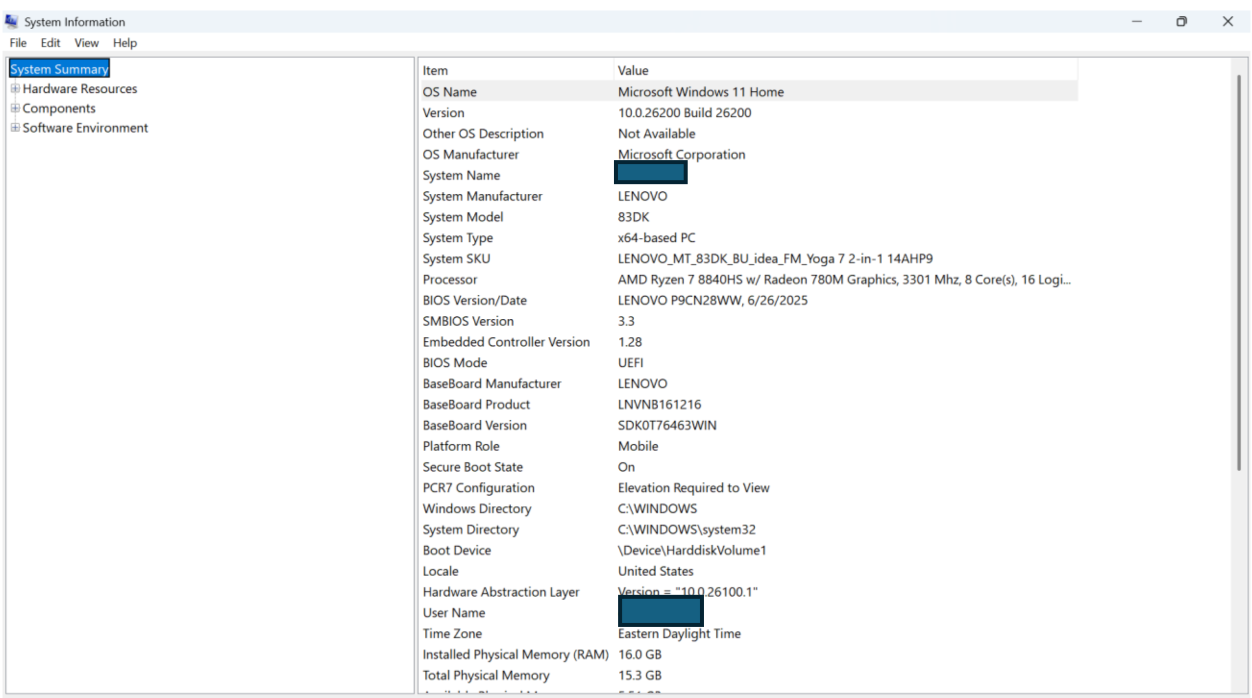
Steps Performed

- Opened the Run dialog (Windows + R).
- Entered msinfo32.
- Reviewed the Windows version, processor, installed RAM, system type, and BIOS mode.

What I Learned

System Information provides key hardware and operating system details that can help an IT technician identify compatibility issues and gather information before troubleshooting.

Screenshot



Task 2: User Account Management

Objective

Learn how Windows user accounts are managed and where common account settings are located.

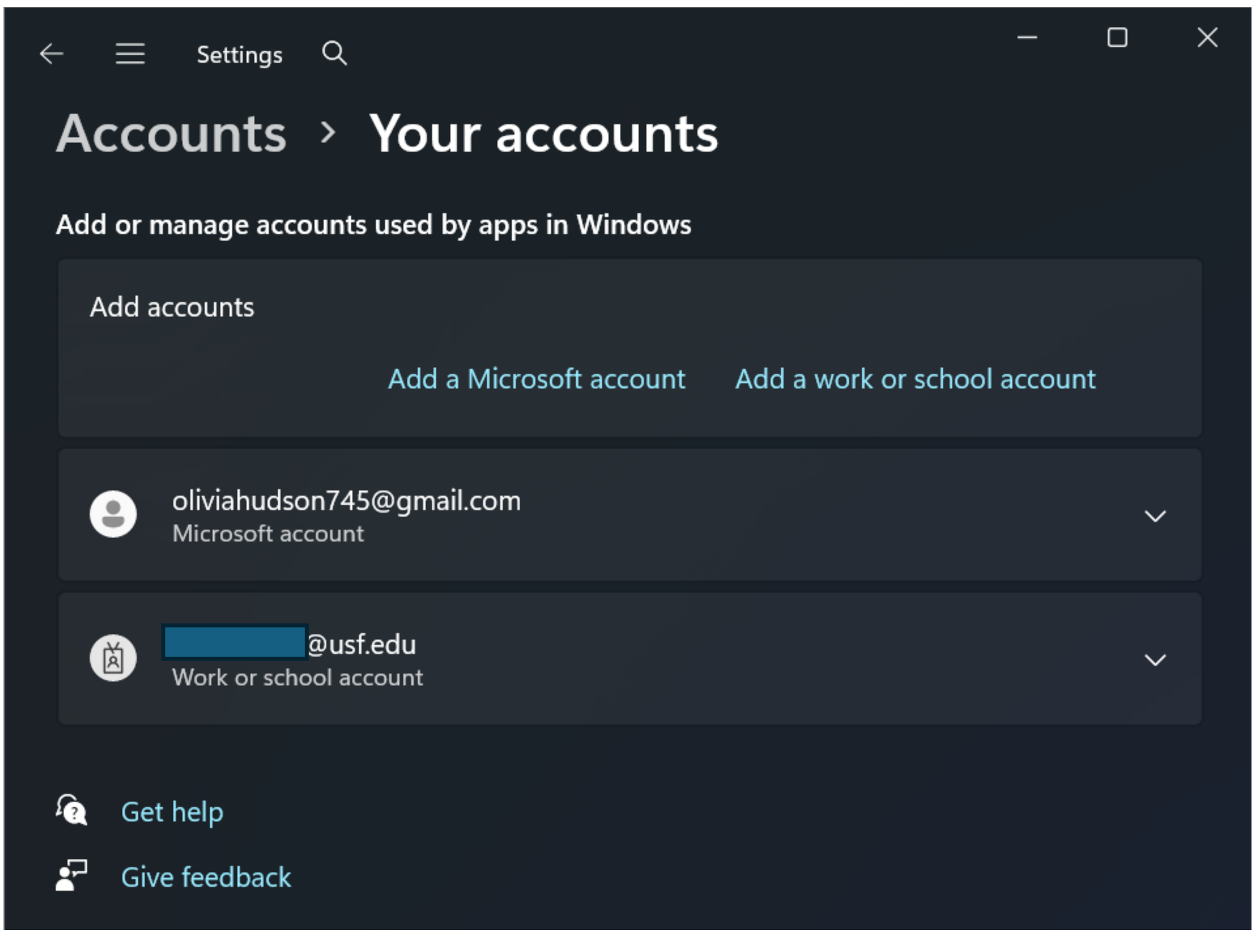
Steps Performed

- Opened Windows Settings and navigated to the Accounts section.
- Reviewed account settings, sign-in options, and user management.

What I Learned

Windows user accounts determine who can access a computer and what permissions they have. IT support technicians frequently manage user accounts, reset passwords, and troubleshoot sign-in issues.

Screenshot



Task 3: Basic Network Diagnostics

Objective

Use Windows Command Prompt to perform basic network diagnostics and verify internet connectivity.

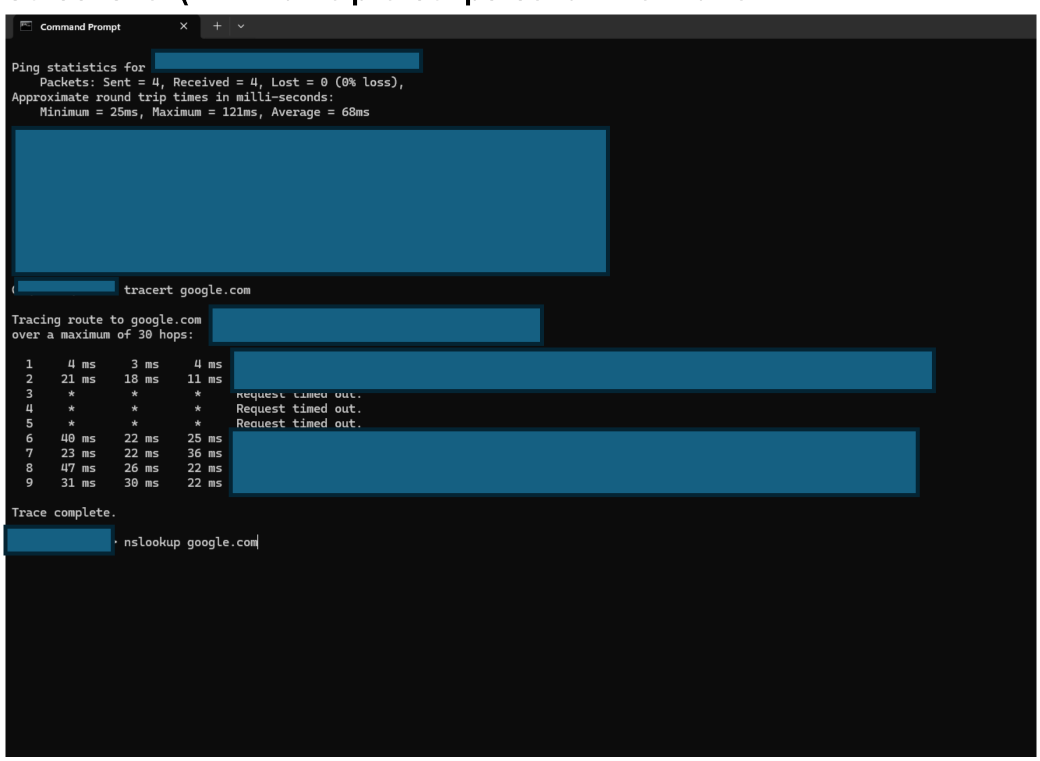
Steps Performed

- Used hostname to identify the computer name.
- Used ipconfig and ipconfig /all to review network configuration.
- Used ping to verify internet connectivity.
- Used nslookup to test DNS resolution.
- Used tracert to observe the network path to a destination.

What I Learned

Command Prompt provides valuable tools for diagnosing network connectivity issues. These commands help IT support technicians verify device configuration, confirm internet access, test DNS resolution, and identify where communication problems may occur.

Screenshot (minimal to protect personal information



Task 4: Device Manager

Objective

Inspect installed hardware devices and review driver information using Windows Device Manager.

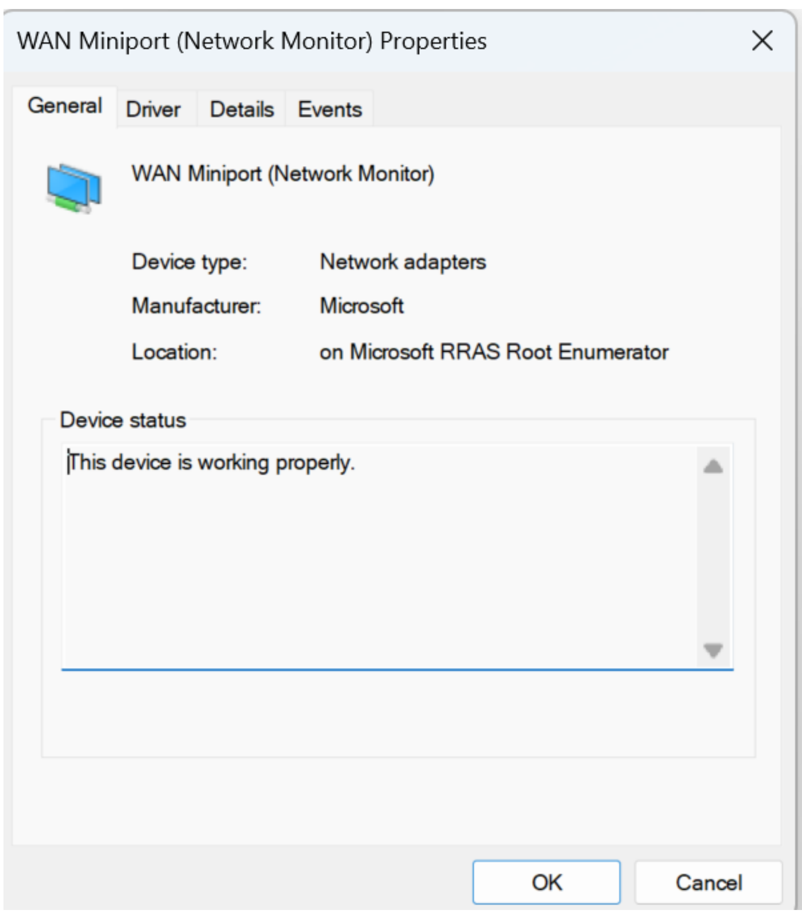
Steps Performed

- Opened Device Manager and reviewed installed hardware.
- Examined the properties of a network device.
- Reviewed device status, driver provider, driver version, and driver date.

What I Learned

Device Manager allows IT technicians to verify that hardware is functioning correctly, identify driver-related issues, and gather information needed to troubleshoot hardware problems.

Screenshot



Task 5: Event Viewer

Objective

Review Windows system events to identify errors and gather diagnostic information.

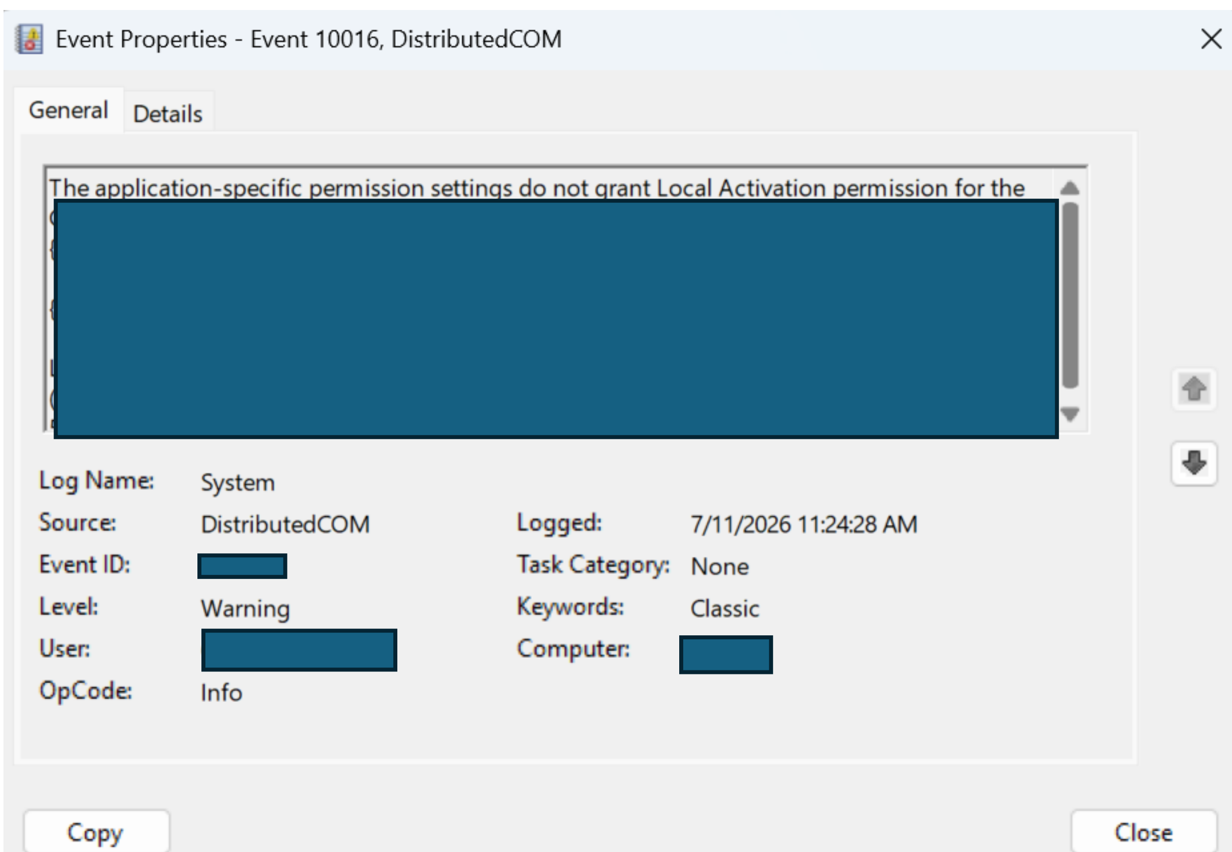
Steps Performed

- Opened Event Viewer and navigated to Windows Logs → System.
- Filtered the log to display Critical, Error, and Warning events.
- Reviewed the details of a system event, including the source, event ID, and description.

What I Learned

Event Viewer stores detailed logs that help technicians identify and investigate operating system, hardware, and application issues. Reviewing event logs can provide valuable information when troubleshooting recurring problems.

Screenshot



Task 6: Task Manager & Performance Monitoring

Objective

Monitor system performance and identify resource usage using Windows Task Manager.

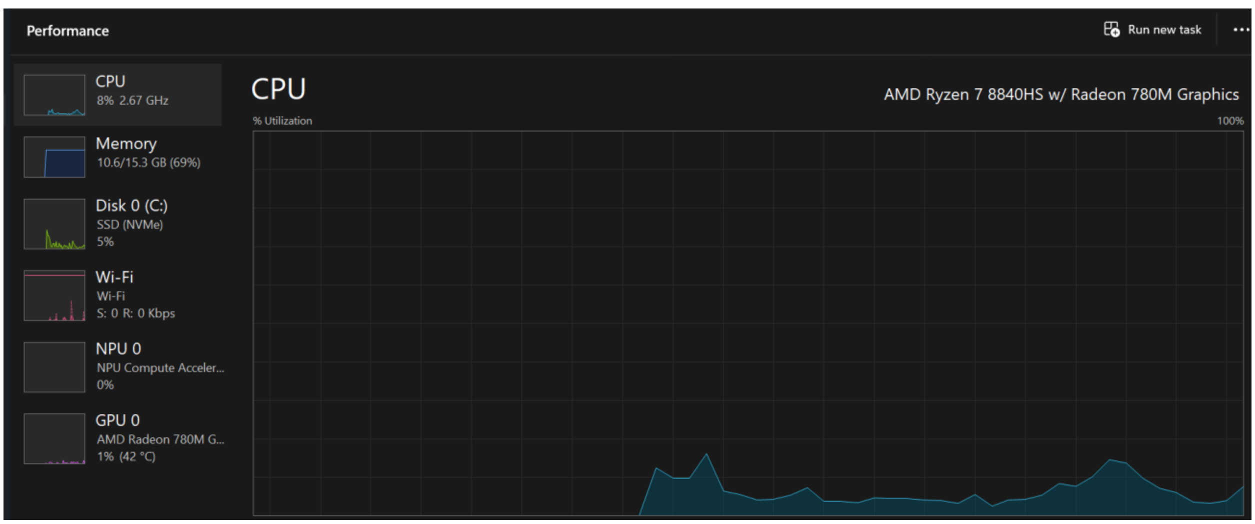
Steps Performed

- Opened Task Manager and reviewed running processes.
- Examined CPU, memory, disk, and network utilization.
- Reviewed startup applications to understand their impact on system performance.

What I Learned

Task Manager allows IT support technicians to identify applications consuming excessive system resources, monitor overall system performance, and troubleshoot slow computer performance.

Screenshot



Project Reflection

Skills Demonstrated

- Windows Administration
- System Information Collection
- User Account Management
- Network Diagnostics
- Hardware & Driver Inspection
- Event Log Analysis
- Performance Monitoring
- Technical Documentation

Key Takeaways

This project introduced me to several Windows administrative tools commonly used in IT support. I gained hands-on experience locating system information, reviewing user accounts, performing basic network diagnostics, inspecting hardware and drivers, analyzing system event logs, and monitoring computer performance. Completing this lab strengthened my understanding of the Windows operating system and the troubleshooting process used by IT professionals.